



DIGAMBAR KAMAT

Chief Minister, Goa

If India has to become a superpower, each state has to become a superpower and if each state has to become a superpower, each individual whether he is living in a village, whether he belongs to the SC, the ST or the OBC category, has to become a superpower and that can be achieved only through education. That is why I agree with Sibalji. This is not the responsibility only of the Centre but has to be a joint effort by the Centre, the states and also the private sector. Only then can we dream of quality education. In Goa, for example, we were pioneers in education right from the time of our first chief minister Dayanand Balkrishna Bandodkar. Our literacy rate has also been good. We have quantity education in Goa but the thrust today has to be on quality education. ”

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passed Class XII—is to the order of 12.4 per cent. In other words, for every 100 children who finish high school, only 12 move to college. But if you look at any developed economy, that percentage is way above 50 per cent. In the US, it is nearly 70 per cent while the global average is around 27 per cent. There is no way that this country can move forward if the gross enrolment ratio remains stagnant at 12.4 per cent because what happens then is that the critical mass of people required to drive creativity, which is the foundation of ideas and intellectual property, is absent. So the only way is to increase the gross enrolment ratio to around